ui Unnatural Intelligence

Charter + events

2026–27 · SAIT, Calgary · Saitsa · Non-academic

Machine learning. From neurons to the papers that moved the field.

Glossary:

Campus / Saitsa

- SECC — Student Experience and Clubs Coordinator (approves events, books rooms, catering)
- CAS — Career Advancement Services (talk to them ≥1 month before a career/employer night)
- ATB — Alberta Treasury Branches (the club bank account)
- VP — Vice-President (Ops = operations, Fin = finance)
- Rubric — Saitsa Clubs Portal (`portal.hellorubric.com`)
- Expo — Clubs Showcase table (fall / winter)
- ui — club mark (“Unnatural Intelligence”)

Money / file

- Rev / Exp — revenue (funding in) / expenses (spend out)

Events / rooms

- E01–E06 — event numbers (First Network → Hack Night)
- MB202 / NK109 — SAIT room codes (fallback classrooms)
- BYO — bring your own (laptop)
- RSVP — reply if you will attend

ML / tech

- ML — machine learning
- AI — artificial intelligence
- LLM — large language model
- GPT-3 — Generative Pre-trained Transformer 3 (the 2020 paper)
- Colab — Google Colaboratory (free notebook in the browser)
- Q/K/V — Query / Key / Value (attention math in the transformer paper)

Club

A club for people who want to understand machine learning — the foundations of neural networks, backpropagation, how architectures actually work, and how the research field changed across the years. We read the papers. We run the math until it is not magic.

Signing seats

Name	Seat	Owns	Does
Daniil Sakov	President	Core + E01 + E06	Direction, veto, rooms with VP Ops, Saitsa face, this pack.
Hailey Pinkham	VP Operations	E05 + submissions	Minutes, Rubric, SECC bookings, Expo, formats proposals.
Pierre Arthur Tchio Seme	VP Finance	E04 + money	Ledger, ATB, quotes, start-up $500, grant lines.

Program

Track	Nights	Owner	Rule
Core	E02 Attention · E03 Few-Shot	Daniil Sakov	Papers and architectures. Pierre does not teach nets.
Gateway	E01 First Network · E04 Make It Act · E05 Play	Daniil Sakov Pierre Arthur Tchio Seme Hailey Pinkham	Walk in. Still ML or a labeled door. Not the identity.
Build	E06 Campus Hack Night	Daniil Sakov	After members exist. Then talk to organizers.

Principles

#	Principle	Meaning
01	Tech club	Chess club plays chess. This one studies machine learning. Tools can show up. They are not the sport.
02	Foundations first	Neurons, matrices, loss, backprop, latent space, then architectures. Agents sit at the far end.
03	Papers are the spine	One paper per core night. First: Attention Is All You Need. Then: Language Models are Few-Shot Learners.
04	Honest first night	Most of SAIT is not technical yet. E01 is still ML: Colab, a network you train, then a paper teaser.
05	Two tracks	Core = papers (President). Gateway = walk-in labs. Attendance decides what we keep.
06	Saitsa structure	Open membership, student-led, non-profit, three signing executives, Clubs Portal. That is rooms, grants, insurance.
07	Teach the stack	Neuron → attention → why language models became a paradigm. Not an ‘AI coding’ workshop.
08	Human finish	Academic honesty. No unedited model captions. If you could not stand behind it, it is not done.

Money

Item	Rule	Number
Grant cap	Per term (1 Jul–31 Dec and 1 Jan–30 Jun). Each activity is its own grant.	$5,000
Start-up	New club. Receipts within 30 days. First come. Lands in ATB on the 15th or 30th.	$500
Swag	Promotional items, at most half that order. Events beat merch.	50%
Will not pay	Alcohol, cannabis, member gifts, grad gifts, SAIT-hosted, spend before approval.	—
Before a grant	Orientation or council + in-person SECC strategy. Quotes on every line. Noon deadline.	—
Sequence	Grant first if the grant pays. Money in ATB. Then Event Proposal. Empty bank = decline.	—
Close-out	Receipts by the approval date or the money comes back. Unused grant is clawed.	—
Approval	Every meeting and event needs a portal form. Unapproved = uninsured, unpaid.	—
Lead time	Most events ≥ 2 weeks. Industry night ≥ 1 month. Career nights: CAS ≥ 1 month.	2 wk / 1 mo
Rooms / food	SECC books. Weekdays after 18:00. On campus, SECC orders the approved vendor.	SECC
Membership	Open. ≥ 75% current SAIT. Year one free. Community members: no vote, no seat.	Free

Expense by night



Expense CAD · scale to $888

Window	Nights	Expense	Vs term cap
Fall 2026 (Jul–Dec)	E01 + E02	$931	$4,069 headroom
Winter 2027 (Jan–Jun)	E03–E06	$2,027	$2,973 headroom
Year	E01–E06	$2,958	Two term caps, not one

Start-up $500

Item	Note	CAD
Print + posters for E01 / Expo	11×17 + one-pagers	$120
Expo table kit (28–29 Oct)	Club mark only; no SAIT logo	$80
Ledger / receipt envelopes	VP Finance	$25
Planned	Leave slack	$225

Year

Month	Move
Sep 2026	Orientation 15th. Signing exec in the room. SECC strategy meeting. Start-up receipts.
Oct 2026	E01. Fall Expo 28–29. No promo until that event's proposal is approved.
Nov 2026	E02. Grant intake 5th, noon.
Jan 2027	Council 16th. E03. Winter Expo 27–28.
Feb 2027	E04 if E01–E03 held a room — or if we need a wider door.
Mar 2027	E05 if needed. E06 if membership exists. Then talk to organizers.
Apr 2027	Annual report 11th. Ledger stays with VP Finance.

File this

Step	Who	What
1	Daniil Sakov	Sign off this Word. Export PDF. That PDF is the overview, not a website.
2	Hailey Pinkham	One Event Proposal per night. Copy type, lead, run table, budget. Attach quotes.
3	Pierre Arthur Tchio Seme	Start-up for E01 (spend → receipt → 30 days) or grant-then-proposal if the grant pays.
4	Hailey Pinkham	Posters 11×17, Saitsa Clubs logo as-is, Saitsa boards, down in 48 h.
5	Night lead	Attendance. Keep / kill. Workbook wants that within a week.

Nights

Code	Title	Track	Type	Lead	When	Head	CAD
E01	Your First Network	Gateway	Lunch & Learn	2 weeks	Oct 2026	Daniil Sakov	$460
E02	Attention Is All You Need	Core	Lunch & Learn	2 weeks	Nov 2026	Daniil Sakov	$471
E03	Language Models are Few-Shot Learners	Core	Lunch & Learn	2 weeks	Jan 2027	Daniil Sakov	$466
E04	Make It Act	Gateway	Social / workshop	2 weeks	Feb 2027	Pierre Arthur Tchio Seme	$429
E05	Play the Network	Gateway	Social	2 weeks	Mar 2027 (or after a thin E01)	Hailey Pinkham	$244
E06	Campus Hack Night	Build	Social	2 weeks (1 month if Industry Night)	Mar–Apr 2027	Daniil Sakov	$888

Dates are windows. Hailey books the room. Attach vendor quotes when a grant is filed.

E01 Your First Network

Field	Detail
Track / type	Gateway · Lunch & Learn · proposal 2 weeks
When / where	Oct 2026 · 90 min · after 18:00 · Heritage Hall (SECC). Fallback MB202 / NK109.
Head / help	Daniil Sakov · Hailey Pinkham, Pierre Arthur Tchio Seme
N / setup / kit	25 · 20 / 15 min · Projector, HDMI, kit, 25 one-pagers, BYO laptop. Colab free.
Purpose	First public night. Leave with a trained network.

Run

Min	Action
0–10	What a neuron is. Why this is not a prompt course.
10–25	Loss and one step of gradient descent.
25–70	Colab: classify a tiny set. Everyone runs it.
70–85	Attention teaser for E02. Not a lecture.
85–90	Rubric RSVP + attendance sheet.

Budget

Side	Item	Note	CAD
Exp	Catering, 25 (coffee / cookies)	SAIT vendor via SECC	$375
Exp	Posters 11×17 × 8	Saitsa boards	$48
Exp	One-pager × 25	Campus print	$22
Exp	Name cards if kit is short	Markers	$15
Rev	Start-up reimbursement	Receipts within 30 days	$460
Net	Expense / funding		$0

E02 Attention Is All You Need

Field	Detail
Track / type	Core · Lunch & Learn · proposal 2 weeks
When / where	Nov 2026 · 90 min · after 18:00 · Heritage Hall (SECC).
Head / help	Daniil Sakov · Hailey Pinkham
N / setup / kit	20–30 · 20 / 15 min · Projector, whiteboard, 20 paper excerpts.
Purpose	Walk the 2017 transformer paper until Figure 1 is not a poster.

Run

Min	Action
0–15	Seq2seq and the recurrence bottleneck.
15–45	Q/K/V, multi-head, positional encoding.
45–70	What changed after 2017.
70–85	Room questions. Read-ahead for E03.
85–90	Attendance.

Budget

Side	Item	Note	CAD
Exp	Catering, 25	SAIT vendor	$400
Exp	Paper excerpts × 20	Campus print	$35
Exp	Posters 11×17 × 6	Saitsa boards	$36
Rev	Clubs Grant — this event	Quotes attached	$471
Net	Expense / funding		$0

Vaswani et al., 2017. Neural-net teaching stays with the President. https://arxiv.org/abs/1706.03762

E03 Language Models are Few-Shot Learners

Field	Detail
Track / type	Core · Lunch & Learn · proposal 2 weeks
When / where	Jan 2027 · 90 min · after 18:00 · Heritage Hall (SECC).
Head / help	Daniil Sakov · Hailey Pinkham
N / setup / kit	20–30 · 20 / 15 min · Projector, 20 abstract + table packets.
Purpose	GPT-3 paper: scaling, in-context learning, what few-shot meant in 2020.

Run

Min	Action
0–15	From transformers to a language model.
15–50	Zero / one / few-shot. The tables that sold it.
50–75	Prompting now vs what the paper measured.
75–90	Point to E04 (tools) and E06 if the room held.

Budget

Side	Item	Note	CAD
Exp	Catering, 25	SAIT vendor	$400
Exp	Print packet × 20	Campus print	$30
Exp	Posters 11×17 × 6	Saitsa boards	$36
Rev	Clubs Grant — this event	Winter intake	$466
Net	Expense / funding		$0

Brown et al., 2020. https://arxiv.org/abs/2005.14165

E04 Make It Act

Field	Detail
Track / type	Gateway · Social / workshop · proposal 2 weeks
When / where	Feb 2027 · 90 min · after 18:00 · Classroom with power (SECC).
Head / help	Pierre Arthur Tchio Seme · Daniil Sakov (tease only), Hailey Pinkham
N / setup / kit	25 · 25 / 15 min · Projector, power bars, install cards.
Purpose	Door for people who will not open a paper first. One working setup, one task, point back.

Run

Min	Action
0–10	What tonight is and is not.
10–40	Everyone gets a working setup.
40–75	One creative task. Hard stop. Show the room.
75–90	Why attention and few-shot are why the toy works.

Budget

Side	Item	Note	CAD
Exp	Catering, 25	SAIT vendor	$375
Exp	Install cards × 25	Campus print	$18
Exp	Posters 11×17 × 6	Saitsa boards	$36
Rev	Clubs Grant — this event	Winter term	$429
Net	Expense / funding		$0

Pierre owns the night. Do not advertise it as what the club is.

E05 Play the Network

Field	Detail
Track / type	Gateway · Social · proposal 2 weeks
When / where	Mar 2027 (or after a thin E01) · 75 min · Small classroom (SECC).
Head / help	Hailey Pinkham · Daniil Sakov
N / setup / kit	20 · 15 / 10 min · Projector, speakers (free SECC kit).
Purpose	Mixer. Training-loop game on the projector.

Run

Min	Action
0–10	What a training loop looks like when error falls.
10–55	Game. Teams pick knobs. No lecture voice.
55–75	Same object as E01–E02. Come back.

Budget

Side	Item	Note	CAD
Exp	Catering, 20	SAIT vendor	$220
Exp	Posters 11×17 × 4	Saitsa boards	$24
Rev	Clubs Grant — this event	Or start-up remainder	$244
Net	Expense / funding		$0

Use if paper nights need a warmer door. Not instead of them.

E06 Campus Hack Night

Field	Detail
Track / type	Build · Social · proposal 2 weeks (1 month if Industry Night)
When / where	Mar–Apr 2027 · 3 h · Lab / classroom with power (SECC).
Head / help	Daniil Sakov · Hailey Pinkham, Pierre Arthur Tchio Seme
N / setup / kit	30 · 30 / 20 min · Projector, power, tables, printed brief.
Purpose	Ship a small demo. Talk to hackathon organizers only after we have members.

Run

Min	Action
0–15	Brief: one problem, one stack from E01–E04.
15–150	Build. Mentors walk. Skill can pick a winner — not a raffle.
150–180	Demos.

Budget

Side	Item	Note	CAD
Exp	Catering, 30, 3 hours	SAIT vendor via SECC	$720
Exp	Briefs + signage	Campus print	$40
Exp	Posters 11×17 × 8	Saitsa boards	$48
Exp	Paid rentals if free kit is short	SECC	$80
Rev	Clubs Grant — this event	Winter term; quotes	$888
Net	Expense / funding		$0

Grant will not cover member gifts. No alcohol. No lottery (fee + prize + chance).